

Implantation The embedding of the fertilized ovum or egg within the wall of the uterus.

Induction The process of artificially starting off labor and keeping it going.

Intravenous drip The infusion of fluids directly into the bloodstream by means of a fine catheter introduced into a vein.

Intravenous injection An injection into a vein.

In vitro fertilization (IVF) A type of assisted conception where fertilization occurs outside the womb and embryos are transferred back into the uterus.

Kangaroo care A technique, adopted especially with premature babies, where baby and parent have prolonged skin-to-skin contact.

Lanugo The soft body hair of the fetus.

Lie The position of the fetus within the uterus.

Linea nigra A line of dark skin that appears down the center of the abdomen over the rectus muscle in some women during pregnancy.

Lochia Postpartum vaginal discharge.

Longitudinal lie The position of the fetus in the uterus in which the spines of the fetus and the mother are parallel.

Low-birthweight baby A baby who weighs below 5 lb 8 oz at birth.

Meconium The first contents of the bowel, present in the fetus before birth and passed during the first few days after birth. The presence of meconium in the amniotic fluid before delivery is usually taken as a sign of fetal distress.

Melasma Pigmentation of the skin that causes darker patches after sun exposure.

Monozygotic See [Twins](#).

Morula A stage in the development of the egg, 3–4 days after fertilization, when it has grown into 16–32 cells.

Nucleus The central part or core of a cell, containing genetic information.

Occiput anterior The position of the baby in the uterus when the back of its head is toward the mother's front.

Occiput posterior The position of the baby in the uterus when the back of its head is toward the mother's back, also referred to as "sunny-side-up."

Opioids (Narcotics) Painkilling meds that induce drowsiness and stupor.

Palpation Feeling the parts of the baby through the mother's abdominal wall.

Pelvic floor The springy muscular structure set within the pelvis that supports the bladder and the uterus, which is weakened during pregnancy.

Perinatal The period from week 24 gestation to 1-4 weeks after delivery.

Perineum The area of soft tissues surrounding the vagina and between the vagina and the rectum.

Posterior See [Occiput posterior](#).

Postpartum After delivery.

Premature A baby born before the 37th week of pregnancy. The baby will have a low birth weight.

Presentation The part of the fetus nearest the cervix.